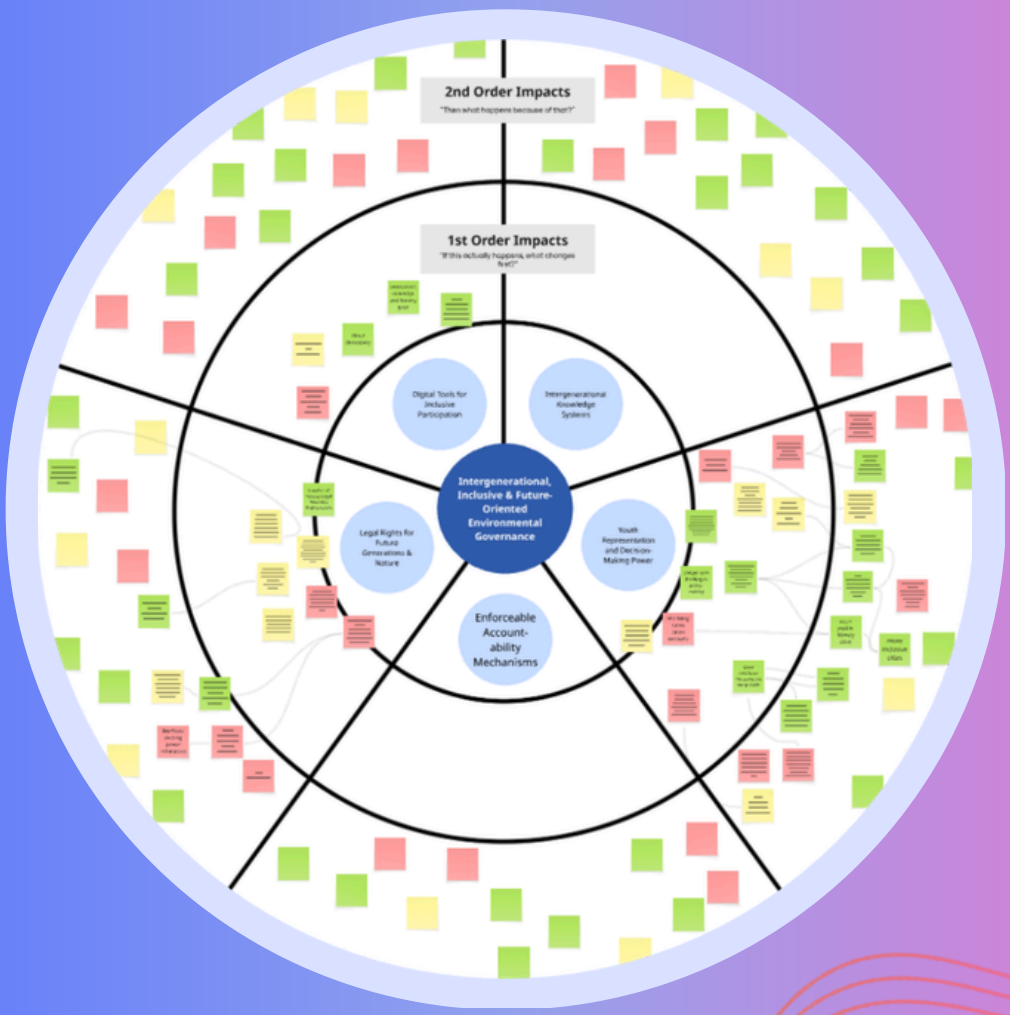
2025

First year of youth-led research on

Intergenerational Equity



Impact Report

Global Youth Coalition

June 2026

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AT A GLANCE

2025 in numbers

1000+

SURVEY RESPONSES

Youth from 140 countries sharing perspectives on intergenerational equity and signals of change

9

WORKSHOPS

Online and hybrid foresight workshops at key global climate and development conferences in 2025

30+

PARTNERS & ALLIES

Across local, national, and multilateral levels for a truly collaborative approach

What we set out to do

- Understand how young people define intergenerational equity
- Imagine desired futures across core thematic areas
- Identify signals & drivers of change for pathways towards possible and desirable futures
- Measure how policies and institutions implement intergenerational equity

How we do it

Phase 1: Global Online Survey

The survey is the basis of understanding:

- How do young people define intergenerational equity?
- What signals, drivers, and trends shape the path toward or away from it?

Phase 2: Foresight Workshops

Building on survey insights, the workshops:

- Identify critical wants, uncertainties, hopes, and challenges for the future of IE
- Three Horizons Models to map pathways for desired futures

Phase 3: Metrics

Building on previous phases, we work together to:

- Explore thematic dimensions of intergenerational equity and related concepts of fairness and justice
- Develop measurable youth-responsive indicators for intergenerational equity

ABOUT THE PROJECT

RESEARCH OBJECTIVES

This youth-led and policy-oriented research project explores how young people understand intergenerational equity, and how they envision futures where its principles are upheld. Based on a common understanding, the project aims to develop a future-oriented, youth-informed framework to ensure intergenerational equity and long-term thinking is embedded in governance, policymaking, and decisions taken today that shape the future.

BACKGROUND

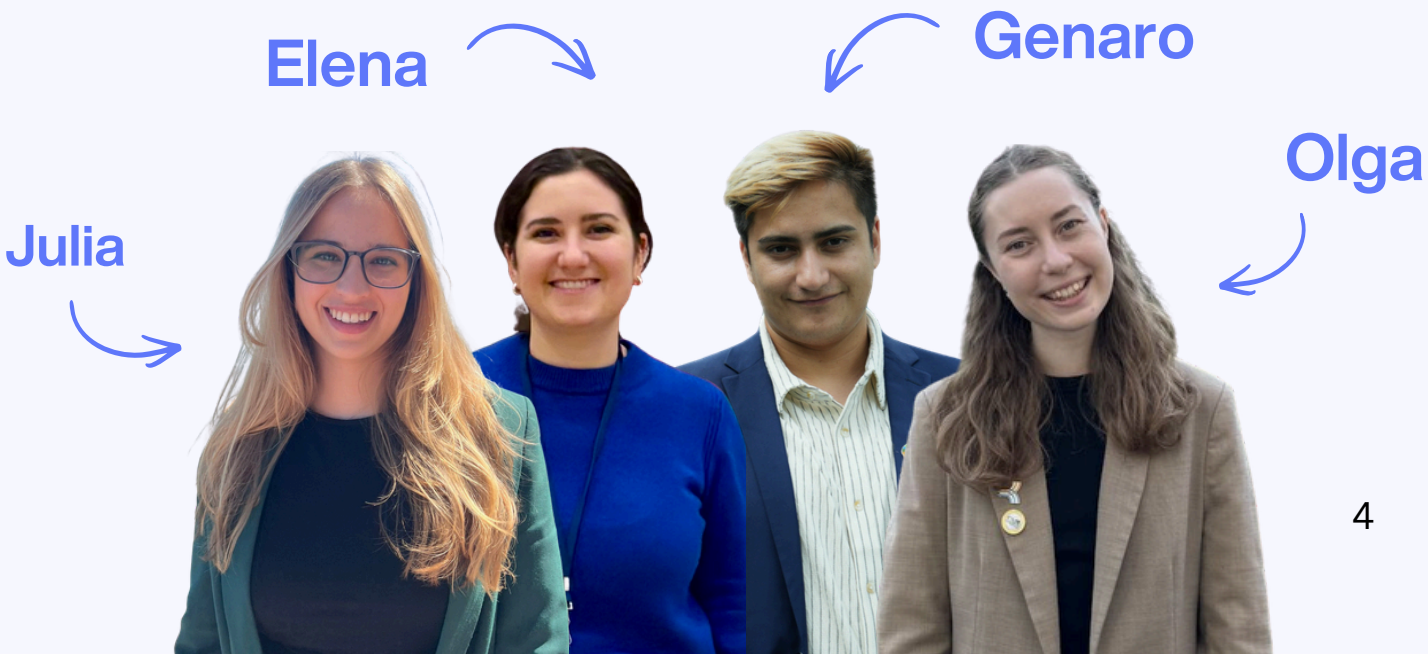
While intergenerational equity is widely recognized in international laws, treaties and climate frameworks, it remains weakly reflected in policy design and implementation. Climate, environmental, and sustainable development responses often overlook how risks, burdens, and opportunities are distributed across generations, particularly for younger populations.

At the same time, young people remain significantly underrepresented in decision-making processes that shape long-term environmental and development outcomes. This lack of generational representation can contribute to short-term policy approaches that insufficiently account for the long-term impacts of today's decisions.

Applying an intergenerational equity lens allows climate and sustainability policies to be assessed based on how they affect present and future generations. Such an approach helps identify opportunities to strengthen long-term resilience, address age-specific vulnerabilities, and ensure that responses to climate change are fair, effective, and future-oriented.

CORE TEAM

We are an interdisciplinary team of young changemakers who are passionate about transforming the multilateral system from an intergenerational perspective.



OUR RESEARCH APPROACH

The research was designed in an iterative way, combining global data collection with online and in-person dialogues and collective reflections. The work unfolded across three interconnected phases that evolved throughout the year.

PHASE 1: GLOBAL SURVEY

The project began with a global online survey open to young people across all regions. Participants were invited to share how they understand fairness between generations, how climate and environmental changes affect their lives, and what kind of future they hope for — or fear. The survey also captured emerging signals and drivers of change including the concerns, values, and stories shaping how young people see long-term change.

PHASE 2: FORESIGHT WORKSHOPS

Alongside the survey, the project brought young people together in a series of foresight workshops held at key moments throughout the year. Using tools like the Three Horizons Framework, Backcasting, and Futures Wheels, participants reflected collectively on how today's decisions shape tomorrow's opportunities — and who bears the cost when they don't. These sessions created space to explore intergenerational equity not just as an idea across time, but as something experienced differently at every stage of life.

PHASE 3: CO-DEVELOPING METRICS AND FRAMEWORKS

Building on what we heard and learned through the survey and workshops, the project is developing practical tools to assess how well climate and sustainability policies actually serve young people and future generations. The goal is to turn lived experience and long-term thinking into metrics that work across different contexts and that policymakers, institutions, and civil society can use to make decisions that are genuinely fair across generations.





TIMELINE

Activities from phases one and two of our project overlap continuously and feed into each other

MAY

Global Survey
Survey of over 1000 young people from 140+ countries, establishing a baseline of global youth perspectives

JULY

FfD-4 in Seville, Spain
Explored signals and visions about Financing for Development in a foresight workshop at the first FfD Children and Youth Conference

SEPTEMBER

New York Climate Week
Foresight Workshop at NYCW on Climate Peace and Security

DECEMBER

CSW70 Call for Inputs
Foresight Workshop on Gender, feeding into CSW70 call for inputs

Phase 1

Phase 2

JUNE

ACUNS Conference
Academic roundtable, "Principle or Practice? Intergenerational Equity Through Youth Lenses"

AUGUST

#YouthLead Workshop
Contributed to UN Youth Office #YouthLead Dialogues

Global Plastics Treaty
Workshop on the Futures of Plastic Governance

NOVEMBER

COY20 in Bélem, Brazil
Workshop on the Futures of Nature, Loss and Damage, Energy Transition

COP30 in Bélem, Brazil
Workshop on the Futures of Food Systems at the Action on Food pavillion

Dubai Futures Forum
Project was selected for the NGFP 2026 Fellowship and attended the Dubai Future Forum

Youth Environment Assembly
Workshop on the Science Policy Interface

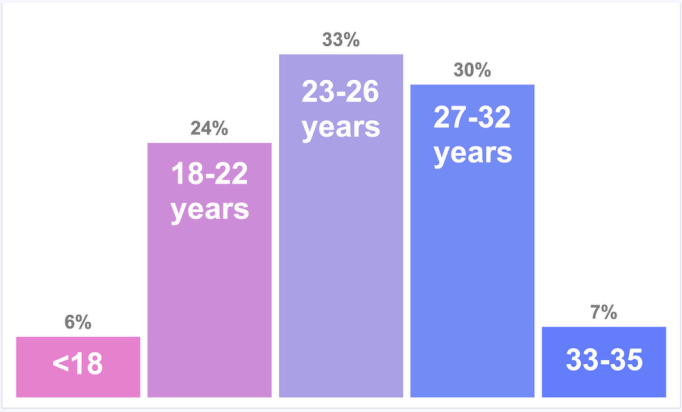
GLOBAL SURVEY

Phase 1

Participant Demographics

27 Questions • 1100+ Respondents • 140+ Countries

Age distribution and representation



The graph shows that most survey participants were young adults, with the largest group aged 23–26 years (33%), followed by 27–32 years (30%). Participants aged 18–22 years represented 24%, while those under 18 and aged 33–35 accounted for 6% and 7%, respectively.

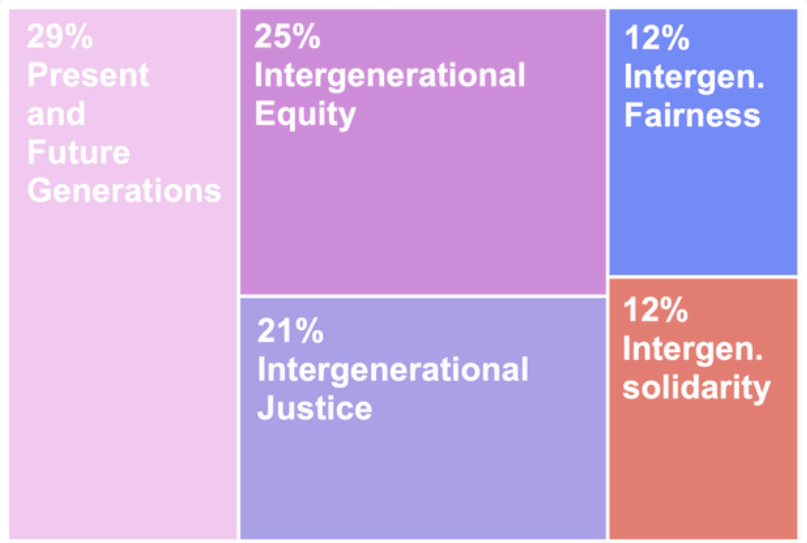
Participants' affiliation

Youth Movement	A local or grassroots youth movement	292
	A university or school-based youth group	236
	An Indigenous youth group or community	102
	A faith-based youth organization or spiritual group	61
UN Youth Constituency	YOUNGO (UN Framework Convention on Climate Change, UNFCCC)	206
	CYMG (UN Environment Program, UNEP)	128
	GYBN (Convention on Biological Diversity, CBD)	76
	MGCY (UN General Assembly and ECOSOC)	75
	UNCCD Youth Caucus (Youth Constituency to the UN Convention to Comb	45
	No affiliation	253
	Other, individually specified	129

Gender distribution



Familiarity with the terms



When asked to select the terms they had heard before, most respondents chose “present and future generations.” Repondents are also familiar with the terms “Intergenerational equity”, “intergenerational justice” and others.

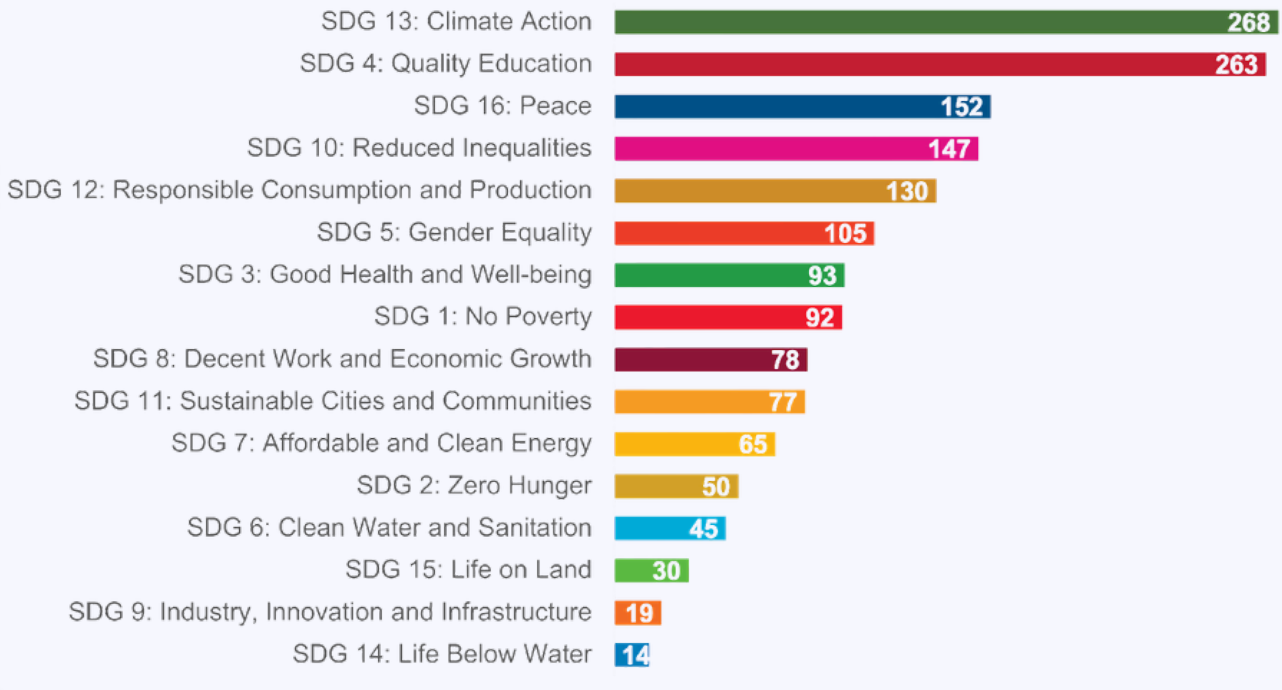
Tensions as obstacles to achieving intergenerational equity

Which of the following tensions are the biggest obstacles to building intergenerational equity?



All tensions were considered relevant obstacles to building intergenerational equity, with trade-offs between short-term objectives and long-term needs standing out as the most significant. A lesser common concern lies in technological advancement.

Sustainable Development Goals most relevant to intergenerational equity



Sectors as drivers to ensure intergenerational equity

From your own perspective, which sectors or areas could help ensure intergenerational equity (Choose up to 3)

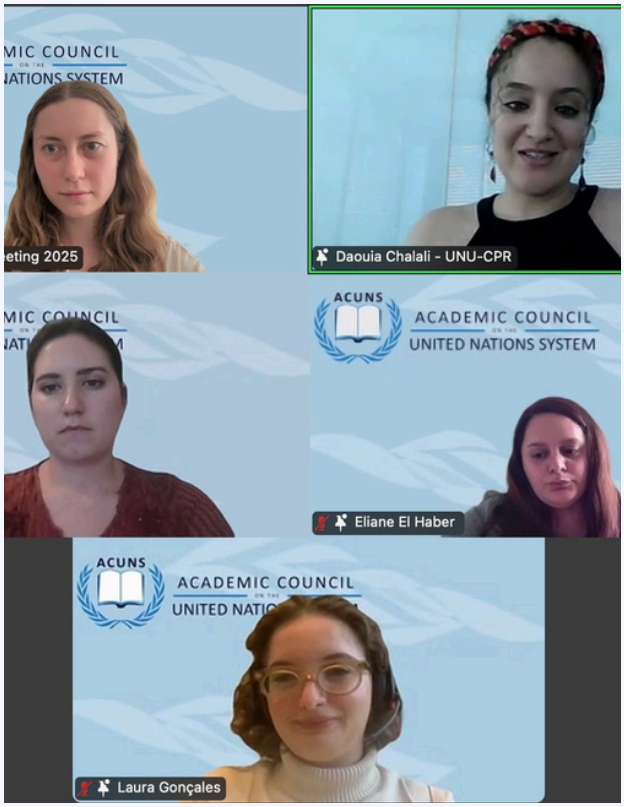


Respondents view system-level actors as the primary drivers of intergenerational equity, with 25% of responses indicating Law, Politics, and Governance as the area in which action to ensure IE can be taken.

WORKSHOPS & EVENTS

Phase 2

Academic Council on the UN System (ACUNS)



July 2025, virtual

Our first academic roundtable took place at the 2025 Annual Meeting of the Academic Council on the United Nations System (ACUNS). Joined by practitioners and youth advocates, we explored the conceptual, legal, and ethical dimensions of intergenerational equity and the role of foresight and futures thinking in advancing the principle.

Our First Foresight Workshop at FfD-4

July 2025, Seville, Spain

Our first foresight workshop took place at the Global Children and Youth Conference on Financing for Development in Seville, Spain. Participants engaged across six breakout groups, using the Three Horizons Framework to imagine the future of financial systems and identify potential drivers of reform.





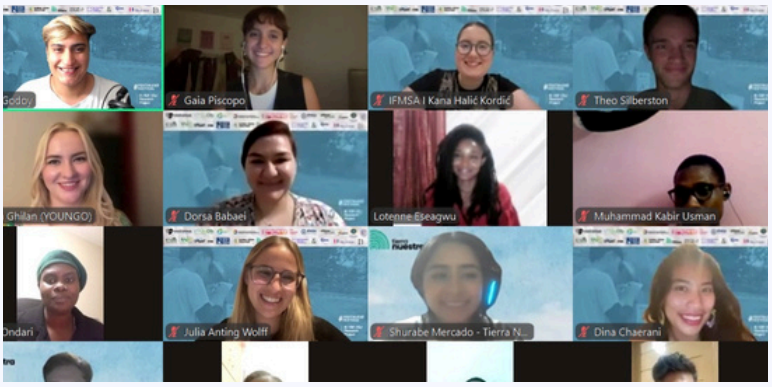
SUBMISSIONS

UN Youth Office's #YouthLead Dialogues

August 2025, virtual

Participants engaged in three horizons exercises across 13 thematic breakout groups, envisioning their desired futures, analysing barriers in the current system, and identifying levers of change. The inputs were taken up by the UN Youth Office's #YouthLead Dialogues.





New York Climate Week

September 2025, NYC, USA

During New York Climate Week, we hosted a foresight workshop on the nexus of climate, peace, and security. Participants explored specific policies and their first, second, and third-order consequences through the Futures Wheel exercise.







UNFCCC COP30 IN BELÉM

UNFCCC COY20 Workshop for COP30

November 2025, Belém, Brazil

In the lead-up to COP30, we hosted a workshop at the Conference of Youth (COY20). Participants analyzed the futures of Nature, Energy & Just Transition, and Loss & Damage, using the Futures Wheels to explore the possible effects of specific policies.





COY20 Climate Finance Workshop

November 2025, Belém

We also hosted a workshop on the futures of climate finance. Using Futures Wheels, participants mapped out the effects of various policies on financial architecture and flows, discussing implications for climate finance.

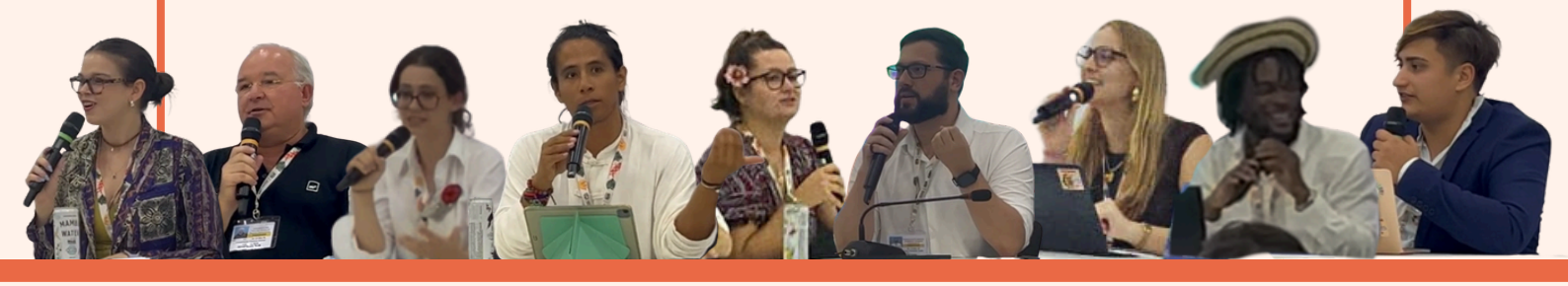


COP30 Intergenerational Equity Side Event

November 2025, Belém



At COP30, we hosted a side event where we presented our initial survey findings. Panelists from civil society, UN agencies, and governments also discussed the role of intergenerational equity in their work and across various thematic areas.



COP30 Workshop: Futures of Food Systems

November 2025, Belém

We also hosted a foresight workshop at the Action on Food Pavilion. Participants envisioned the futures of food systems and mapped out the potential consequences of specific policies by engaging in three foresight exercises: the three horizons, backcasting, and futures wheels.









NGFP FELLOWSHIP







Dubai Futures Forum

November 2025, Dubai, UAE

In November, we had the honor of being selected for the 2026 Next Generation Foresight Practitioners Fellowship by the School of International Futures. To kick off the fellowship, we headed to the Dubai Futures Forum, where we met the network that will be supporting us over the course of the fellowship, participated in workshops, and learned from experts in the foresight community. We also connected with other fellows in our cohort, exploring synergies and avenues for future collaboration.



UN ENVIRONMENT PROGRAMME

Global Plastics Treaty, INC-5.2

August 2025, Geneva, Switzerland

At INC-5.2, as part of the Youth Preparatory Meeting, we co-hosted a workshop on the future of the Global Plastics Treaty. With over 80 participants, we discussed business-as-usual, mapped out what radically and intergenerationally fair plastics governance could look like, and how youth priorities could be reflected in the treaty text.



Science-Policy Interface, Youth Environment Assembly

December 2025, Nairobi, Kenya

At the Youth Environment Assembly, we co-hosted a workshop on the Future of the Environmental Science-Policy Interface where participants explored how science can be fit-for-purpose and better inform decision-making.



ACRONYMS

ACUNS	Academic Council on the United Nations System
COY	Conference of Youth
COP	Conference of the Parties to the UNFCCC
CSW	Commission on the Status of Women
FfD	Financing for Development
FfD-4	Fourth International Conference on FfD
IE	Intergenerational Equity
IGF	Intergenerational Fairness
NGFP	Next Generation Foresight Practitioners
NYCW	New York Climate Week
SDGs	Sustainable Development Goals
UN	United Nations
UNEA	United Nations Environment Assembly

ABOUT THE CORE TEAM

OLGA SKAREDINA



Olga Skaredina is a Ph.D. candidate in Public Policy at Northeastern University who combines her passion for global environmental governance with active engagement in youth advocacy. She holds an interdisciplinary background, with focused interests in intergovernmental decision-making, youth agency, and intergenerational equity. Her involvement as a youth representative extends to various UN meetings, including the United Nations Environment Assembly, the Science-Policy Panel on Chemicals, Waste, and Pollution, Global Plastics Treaty negotiations, and more.

ELENA MARIA MUELLER



Elena Müller is a graduate in Business Innovation and Managing Climate Solutions from the University of St. Gallen, with a research track record in public sector innovation and financing the green transition. She interned in the European Commission, Swiss Federal Department of Foreign Affairs and ZOE Institute. She currently serves as the Swiss Climate Youth Delegate 2025-2027 and represents young people in the UNFCCC. Elena is an active member of Swiss Youth for Climate, where she co-leads the policy work of the international climate policy working group.

GENARO GODOY GONZÁLEZ



Genaro Godoy González is Head of Research and Policy and an AI systems developer at the Global Youth Coalition. He also serves as a Global Focal Point to the Financing for Development Youth Constituency of the Major Group for Children and Youth. Genaro has led policy research, authored policy papers, designed capacity development programs, and engaged with the official youth constituencies to the UNFCCC and UNEP. He has also served as a youth negotiator for the Chilean delegation to the UNFCCC, following tracks on climate and development finance, with a particular focus on adaptation, nature, just transition, Article 6, and loss and damage.

JULIA ANTING WOLFF



Julia Anting Wolff serves as Programme Officer for Economic Affairs at the Major Group for Children and Youth. She is a recent graduate of University College London in International Relations and Economics, with focused interests in sustainable finance and leveraging public-private partnerships for development. She is an advocate for intergenerational equity and embedding futures-thinking in policy.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

We are grateful to our partners for sharing our vision of a just future for present and future generations and for supporting our work throughout the different project cycles.

Collaborating with:

- Youth Negotiators Academy
- Intergenerational Center for Global Action
- Global Environmental Governance (GEG) Project
- Intergenerational Center for Global Action (ICGA)
- Major Group for Children and Youth (MGCY)
- Global Youth Biodiversity Network (GYBN)
- Children and Youth Major Group to UNEP (CYMG)
- FfD Children and Youth Constituency

With technical support from:

- UNICEF Innocenti
- School of International Futures

With outreach support from:

- United Nations Youth Office
- Oxford Net Zero

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Global Youth Coalition

Learn more about the project
on our website:

https://theglobalyouth.co/Foresight-Research

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Global Youth Coalition